

r/LocalLLaMA

Are we headed toward a world of cheap subsidized AI, expensive clean water and expensive local electricity?

Posted by u/Beestinge • 0 points • 31 comments

Would a good reason to use a local AI is to simply show that the desire for AI is not that high? I was thinking about how electricity has gone up since AI datacenters are using more electricity, clean water is now being used for cooling, and how it will become more of a luxury item as time goes on. I saw a [topic]

(https://old.reddit.com/r/LocalLLaMA/comments/1nhx3jp/whats_the_most_costeffective_and_best_ai_model/) about when to use local AI and basically its not a good idea with subsidized AI, but at what cost?

Comments

u/bryseeayo • 1 points • 2025-09-16 17:00 UTC

<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/i-cant-find-any-instances-of-data>

u/Beestinge • 1 points • 2025-09-16 17:18 UTC

Not a single instance of mentioning the water table or the aquifers. It mentions groundwater twice.

u/Baphaddon • 0 points • 2025-09-16 16:41 UTC

Good point

u/badgerbadgerbadgerWI • 1 points • 2025-09-16 16:33 UTC

It is an interesting double-edged sword; the next generation of smaller models is made possible by the frontier models (and a lot of processing, training, testing, etc). Even DeepSeek probably used OpenAI to train its model.

100% agree on the future, though - local AI for 80% of the workload, then frontier models for the 20% that require higher-level reasoning and creativity.

I think we are 2-3 years away from being able to affordably run great models locally (we can run some pretty good ones on Macbooks, Franken-Linux boxes, and dev-kits, but to make it more universal, a \$1000 unit will need to be shipped that can do LLM, SLM, Vision, TTS, SST, have memory/RAG/data pipelines, access to agents, and be open enough to bring in new models, etc.

It's coming though!